

HR Interview — Preparation Notes

PlacementPrep Study Notes

1. Tell Me About Yourself

Structure your answer: Present -> Past -> Future.

- Present: your current role/degree and key skill area.
- Past: a relevant achievement or project that shaped your interest.
- Future: why you're excited about this specific role/company.

2. The STAR Technique

Used to answer behavioral questions with a clear structure.

- Situation: briefly set the context.
- Task: what you were responsible for.
- Action: the specific steps YOU took.
- Result: the outcome, ideally with a measurable impact.

3. Common Questions & Approach

Prepare structured answers, not memorized scripts.

- 'What is your biggest weakness?' — share a genuine one plus the steps you're taking to improve.
- 'Why should we hire you?' — connect your specific skills to the role's specific needs.
- 'Where do you see yourself in 5 years?' — show ambition aligned with realistic growth in the field.

4. Salary Negotiation Basics

Preparation and research matter more than a specific number.

- Research the market rate for the role and location beforehand.
- Let the employer bring up salary first where possible.
- It is acceptable to ask for time to consider an offer.

Practice Tip

- Practice answers out loud, not just in your head — timing and tone matter.
- Keep answers to 60-90 seconds; avoid rambling.